

For the webmaster, information about the browsing environment will allow modifying the site to suit the majority of customers. For example, if reports suggest that only 5 per cent of visitors are using Flash-enabled browsers, the webmaster can decrease Flash content to allow the majority of the users to experience to the fullest what the site has to offer. (Just by the way, all charts in GA are Flash-based.)

For the Executive, nothing is as important as knowing where all the advertising budget is being utilised and whether it is generating returns. With reports that track Return on Investment on different types of marketing campaigns, GA can allow the executive to decide the proportion of the budget allocation across all marketing efforts.

Limitations

Since the data collection requires the running of a script, GA is susceptible to browser modification. So if users to the site are using JavaScript-disabled browsers, the script will not be loaded. Ad blockers can be configured to block data from specific ad sites, including google-analytics.com. Users using these applications can browse the site and yet not leave a trace.

Concluding Remarks

The ability to track the whole gamut of marketing efforts at one end, and to generate relevant reports to address the needs of different levels of employees at the other end makes GA an irreplaceable tool for any online business. The use of Flash ads makes saving the graphs for offline access difficult.